

Time zones map

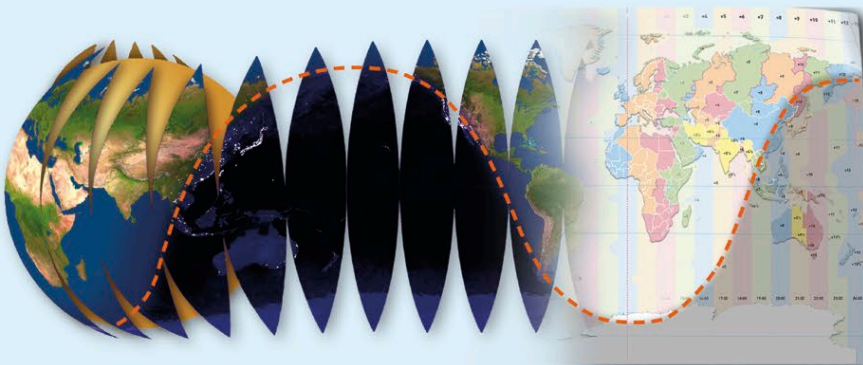
The map shows the time of day at 12 noon Coordinated Universal Time (UTC), the base from which all times are set. The columns are time zones labeled with the number of hours they are ahead or behind UTC. If you stood halfway between the boundaries of a time zone with your watch set to the correct time, at 12 noon the sun would be at its highest point.

Time zones

As Earth rotates, some of it faces the sun and the rest is in darkness. Since the sun is high in the sky at noon, noon is at different times in different places. We adjust by splitting the Earth into time zones.

Day and night

On the globe of Earth, we can see day and night divided by a straight line from north to south. When the Earth is laid flat as on the map here, the light and dark areas form a bell shape.



Northern summer

The Earth is tilted. When the North Pole tilts toward the sun and the South Pole leans away, it is summer in the northern hemisphere (northern half of the world) and winter in the southern hemisphere, as on the main map.

